

composer's wife, Mathilde, led to the artist's suicide in 1908, the year after he painted this piece, Self-Portrait, Laughing.

Schoenberg made reference to the disastrous triangular relationship in a number of his works.



PIERROT LUNAIRE, 1912

This is a poster for the Berlin premiere of Arnold Schoenberg's melodrama *Pierrot Lunaire*, which sets verses from the work of the same name by the Belgian Symbolist poet Albert Giraud.

Refuge and change

This period of tranquility was ended by the rise to power of Adolf Hitler's anti-Semitic Nazi Party in 1933. Along with all other Jewish teaching staff in Germany, Schoenberg was dismissed from his post. He sought refuge abroad, settling in Los Angeles in 1934. Persecution triggered his formal readoption of the Jewish faith. His opera *Moses und Aron*, abandoned unfinished in 1932, had already presaged this return to his religious roots with its